

37TH DISTRICT
MATT SMITH
SENATE BOX 203037
THE STATE CAPITOL
HARRISBURG, PA 17120-3037
717-787-5839
FAX: 717-772-4437

319 CASTLE SHANNON BLVD.
PITTSBURGH, PA 15234
412-571-2169
FAX: 412-571-2000

PETERS TWP. MUNICIPAL BUILDING
610 EAST McMURRAY ROAD
McMURRAY, PA 15317
724-942-7210
FAX: 724-942-7211
TUESDAY AND THURSDAY
EMAIL: SenatorSmith@pasenate.com
WEBSITE: www.SenatorMattSmith.com



Senate of Pennsylvania

COMMITTEES

STATE GOVERNMENT, DEMOCRATIC CHAIR
COMMUNITY, ECONOMIC
& RECREATIONAL DEVELOPMENT
CONSUMER PROTECTION
& PROFESSIONAL LICENSURE
FINANCE
GAME & FISHERIES

April 8, 2013

Secretary Richard J. Allan
Department of Conservation and Natural Resources
Bureau of Recreation and Conservation
Rachel Carson State Office Building
400 Market Street, 5th Floor
Harrisburg, PA 17101-8475

Dear Secretary Allan:

I write to provide my support for the Borough of Coraopolis and their application to the Community Conservation Partnerships Program (C2P2) administered by the Pennsylvania Department of Conservation and Natural Resources (DCNR). The Borough of Coraopolis, in conjunction with the non-profit Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC), is seeking assistance from the C2P2 grant program in the amount of \$200,000.

The ORTC's master plan develops a corridor of over forty miles of multi-use land and water trail systems along the Ohio River and its tributaries. This corridor extends from the source of the Ohio River in Coraopolis to the tri-state intersection of West Virginia, Ohio, and Pennsylvania where it will connect to the Great Lakes region via the Great Ohio Lake-to-River Greenway. Within the Pittsburgh region, the Ohio River Trail will connect two recreational projects: the seventy-eight acre Allegheny County Sports & Athletic Complex and the Moon Township Waterfront Park – both current brownfield sites undergoing reclamation through the Environmental Protection Agency's Partnership for Sustainable Communities Area-Wide Brownfields Planning Project.

In 2012, the Federal Highway Administration awarded the ORTC a \$200,000 Transportation, Community and System Preservation Program Grant for the development of their phase one Ohio River Trail project. With a matching award from DCNR's C2P2 grant program, the ORTC can begin implementation of engineering specifications, bid documents, and start construction on over two miles of the Ohio River Trail from Coraopolis through Moon Township and into Sewickley Borough. As you may be aware, in 2009 DCNR awarded the ORTC and eight south shore communities a planning grant which identified a series of proposed recommendations to create a greenway along the Ohio River corridor and improve public access to it. With this

planning study, the ORTC developed plans for their first phase of the Ohio River Trail and are now seeking a grant for its initial implementation.

In conclusion, I fully support the efforts of the Borough of Coraopolis as they seek external funding to construct the Ohio River Trail. Any project that connects our communities, particularly with a natural greenway, will exponentially benefit the entire region.

Thank you for your consideration of my letter. Please feel free to contact me if you have any questions or concerns.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read 'Matt Smith', with a stylized flourish extending to the right.

MATT SMITH
State Senator
37th Senate District
www.SenatorMattSmith.com

cc: Lauren Imgrund, Director Bureau of Recreation and Conservation